

Blair Christopher

Senior Product Design Leader

Richmond, VA

badnewsblair@icloud.com

[linkedin.com/in/badnewsblair](https://www.linkedin.com/in/badnewsblair)

anyblair.com

SUMMARY

Senior design leader with 20 years of experience across product design, design systems, and developer tools in complex, regulated environments. I've built and led teams, shipped products, and created the structural conditions where great design becomes repeatable. I bridge IC and management because I've had to do both at the same time, at scale. *I use AI as a tool in service of craft and judgment, not as a substitute for either.*

CORE STRENGTHS

- Product Design Leadership
- Design Systems at Scale
- Accessibility as Default
- People Management and Hiring
- Cross-Functional Partnership
- Platform and Portfolio Design
- Governance and Adoption Strategy
- DesignOps and Process Design
- Executive Stakeholder Alignment

EXPERIENCE

GEICO

Hybrid (Richmond, VA / Fredericksburg, VA / Chevy Chase, MD)

Director, *Design Systems*

2023 - 2025

Hue Design System

- Led design and modernization of Hue, GEICO's enterprise-wide design system, transitioning approximately 50% of inventory to Web Components and delivering 8 new components, 55 Web Components, and 15 updated icons
- Architected the Blue Button Initiative, a strategic adoption campaign driving system upgrades across 40+ application teams, shifting culture from gatekeeping to collaborative enablement
- Mentored and managed a cross-functional team of designers and engineers, supporting performance management and career development
- Partnered with Engineering, Brand, and Product across 10 application teams to establish accessibility standards at scale and reduce platform fragmentation

Product Design Manager

2021 - 2023

Manage and Plan Stage

- Led two teams of 4 designers across the Manage and Plan Stages, supporting project management, planning tools, and OKR workflows in a fully remote environment
- Designed and shipped OKR Management from zero, launching to 100% of GitLab employees and the highest consumer tier
- Built end-to-end design process: structured discovery, collaborative ideation, weekly critique, validation checkpoints, and engineering handoff standards
- Established design review cadence and sprint model that reduced late-stage pivots and improved PM and Engineering alignment

CAPITAL ONE

Richmond, VA

Senior Design Manager, Developer Platforms

2020 - 2021

- Established vision and design strategy for a unified internal developer platform, securing funding and building a dedicated design team
- Led Jobs-to-Be-Done workshops with dozens of engineers and stakeholders to define key problems and opportunities
- Partnered with Product and Engineering leaders across lines of business to align on platform strategy and enable scalable adoption

Design Manager, Developer Tools

2018 - 2020

- Owned design delivery for a Chaos Engineering platform, shaping workflows and integrations to support real-world developer needs
- Translated complex technical concepts into intuitive, accessible experiences in close partnership with Engineering

Design Manager, Mobile Product Design

2013 - 2018

- Directed design for multiple generations of Capital One's iPad servicing app (EASE), leading all design for v2 and originating the EASE unified design language adopted across the iOS platform
- Collaborated with Apple's design and engineering teams in Cupertino on Touch ID and Face ID for Capital One
- Contributed to back-to-back J.D. Power awards and a Webby Award for the iOS app
- Hybrid IC/Manager for Bank, Card, and Enterprise features across the iOS Universal App

Senior Art Director, Brand and Digital Experiences

2007 - 2013

- Sole designer of the Capital One Venture Card physical product, from concept through production
- Designed Capital One's first iPhone app and early digital product experiences

EDUCATION AND DEVELOPMENT

- George Mason University, Bachelor of Arts, Graphic Design
- Nielsen Norman Group: DesignOps, Scaling UX, Designing Complex Applications
- Scaled Agile, Inc.: Implementing SAFe 5.1

TOOLS AND METHODS

Figma, Figma Make, MCP, Web Components, Design Tokens, Jobs-to-Be-Done, Agile/SAFe, DesignOps, OKRs, WCAG Accessibility Standards, AI-assisted workflows (Claude, Cursor)